

China

The Chinese government funds the National Center for Nano Science and Technology and the National Engineering Research Center for Nanotechnology, for carrying on R&D activities in nanotechnology. Other nanotechnology centers in China include the CAS Nanotechnology Research Center, Nanomaterials and Development Application Center, and the Surface Science, Nanotechnology and Engineering Center.

India

In 2001, India launched their National Nanoscience and Technology Initiative and its activities are divided into three areas:

- ▶ Research including synthesis and assembly, characterization of properties, and applications.
- ▶ Education, supporting advanced schools, symposia, and training workshops for researchers and scholars.
- ▶ Industry, emphasising interaction with industries in a variety of areas, such as nanoelectronics, nanopower/particle production, and surface coatings.

The emergence of nanotechnology in India has witnessed the engagement of a diverse set of players, each with their own agenda and role. Nanotechnology in India is a government led initiative and nanotechnology R&D barring a few exceptions is largely being ensued at public funded universities as well as research institutes.

Department of Science and Technology (DST), the chief agency engaged in the development of nanotechnology, initiated India's principal programme, the Nanoscience and Technology Mission (NSTM) in 2007, with an allocation of Rupees 1000 crores for a period of five years. Apart from DSIT, the other key players include:

- ▶ DBT (Department of Biotechnology) which supports research in nanotechnology and the lifesciences.
- ▶ CSIR (Council of Scientific and Industrial Research) which is a network of 38 laboratories has commissioned R&D in nanotechnology in diverse areas.
- ▶ SERC (Science and Engineering Research Council) has also aided projects on nanotechnology.

Several bilateral collaborations have emerged in nanoscience and technology, as it was a part of nearly all the Science & Technology (S&T) agreements between India and other countries. Initiatives for joint R&D have figured prominently with Indian institutes engaging in projects of similar kind in the US, EU, Japan, Taiwan and Russia. The S&T departments of Brazil, South Africa and India